

Speed Up your Research Paper with **zotero**



Zotero is an amazing open source tool that helps writers to manage the various references used in their articles and presentations. Essentially, it helps them to add these references to their articles with minimal drudgery but with clinical precision.

Pose this question to any research scholar, "What is the most laborious task while preparing a research paper or thesis?" More often than not, the answer will be *reference management*. It is true that managing references when writing research articles requires clinical precision. To beef up the paper, the references need to be handled in various formats for different journals, conferences, publishers, etc.

Managing references involves two major phases: the first is to organise the vast collection of bibliographic items gathered over a period of time, as a good library; the second is to search this library and cite them in manuscripts that you prepare. It wasn't long ago that all these things were carried out with very little intervention from software. Then came software that could assist both in managing the reference collection as well as in incorporating citations in the required format within the manuscripts. These software are called reference managers and an array of them, both proprietary and open source, are available now. This article highlights Zotero

—the leading open source reference manager.

Reference managers: Whom do they aid?

Though reference managers are widely used by research scholars, this practice is not restricted to researchers and scientists alone. Reference managers can be used by any one preparing a project report, school or college assignment, or someone writing a thesis, a book or articles for reputed magazines. In general, reference managers are handy for all those whose writing involves citing the original sources of the article or book's contents.

A point to be noted is that publishing a paper or article by using already published content, without adding citations to the source, is known as plagiarism, which would lead to copyright infringement. In the research community, plagiarism is considered to be a serious issue. A reference manager makes your life simpler by adding and removing references swiftly.